RAYMOND HUGHES

AI Engineer · Solutions Architect · Ruby on Rails Tech Lead

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

AI Engineer and Solutions Architect with over a decade of Ruby on Rails experience and deep hands-on expertise building production-grade agentic systems, LLM integrations, and event-driven architecture. Currently serving as Architect on the VA Appeals modernization program alongside Booz Allen Hamilton, owning technical direction across multiple platforms and leading a team-wide AI tooling transformation. Equally comfortable designing systems from scratch, aligning stakeholders on technical roadmaps, and mentoring engineers — with seven years of additional domain depth in behavioral health EHR systems.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Take2 Consulting, LLC — U.S. Dept. of Veterans Affairs

Mar 2023 – Present

Solutions Architect / AI Engineer Lead

VA Appeals Modernization · Booz Allen Hamilton Partnership

Serving as Architect on the VA Appeals program, owning technical direction across Caseflow, eFolder Express, and the appeals-consumer Kafka platform. Designed and shipped autonomous AI agents for test generation, documentation synthesis, and intelligent PR review — alongside the Appeals Agent Toolkit, a shared GitHub Copilot configuration layer that standardized AI tooling across the engineering team. Architected a multi-product MCP integration enabling AI assistants to operate with cross-system context, pioneered anchor comment patterns for durable in-code AI context, and led a spec-driven development rollout that formalized how the team builds with AI from day one.

Carepaths Inc.

May 2016 – Mar 2023

Senior Software Engineer

Spent seven years building and scaling a HIPAA-compliant behavioral health EHR platform serving thousands of clinicians. Delivered full FHIR/HL7 integration with QRDA and CDA import/export, an in-app fax service, a cross-platform outcomes-tracking mobile app, a psychologist directory with scheduling and ratings, and a full frontend redesign. Maintained strict HIPAA compliance across all system layers and mentored engineers through coaching, code review, and technical guidance.

A1 Roof Trusses

Nov 2014 – Nov 2015

Software Engineer I

Developed and maintained proprietary truss design software used in manufacturing operations and managed connected device network infrastructure across the organization.

Cypress Communications Inc.

Oct 2006 – May 2013

Systems Engineer

Installed and maintained commercial VoIP and cable systems for enterprise clients, managing customer relationships and resolving technical escalations to ensure quality of service.

EDUCATION

Keiser University

GPA 3.85 · Graduated with High Honors

B.S. in Software Engineering · Jan 2013 – Dec 2016

T E C H N I C A L S K I L L S

AI & Agents: LLM Integration · Agentic Pipelines · MCP · GitHub Copilot · Claude Code · RAG · Prompt Engineering · Spec-Driven Development

Backend: Ruby on Rails · Apache Kafka · SQS/Shoryuken · Event-Driven Architecture · REST APIs

Frontend: JavaScript · React · HTML/CSS

Cloud & DevOps: AWS (EC2, S3) · Docker · GitHub Actions · Dynatrace · New Relic · OpenTelemetry

Healthcare: HIPAA · HL7 · FHIR · QRDA/CDA · VBMS Architecture

Leadership: Technical Architecture · Team Mentorship · Agile/Scrum · Stakeholder Alignment · Jira